

Things to Look at While Choosing an IaaS Provider

This guide will serve as a checklist when choosing the best IaaS provider for your organisation, from amongst the host of options available.



According to Gartner's latest forecast, global spending on IaaS is expected to reach almost US\$ 16.5 billion in 2015, an increase of 32.8 per cent from 2014. The compound annual growth rate (CAGR) from 2014 to 2019 is forecast to be 29.1 per cent. Sunil Gupta, executive director and president, Netmagic Solutions, shares, "Investments in Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) solutions will be fuelled by the IT Infrastructure expansion happening across Indian enterprises within the service sector, in verticals such as banking, insurance and telecom, as well as within the government segment. IaaS will see a lot of traction, both from large to mid-market enterprises that want to replace their outdated infrastructure, and from small and medium businesses (firms with less than 999 employees). They will be attracted by the promise of developing best-of-breed infrastructure at a low acquisition and maintenance cost. In the near future, usage of data centre and co-location solutions is expected to percolate down to medium and small businesses as well.

Moreover, the government of India's aggressive digitisation plans, as well as the need for documentation of records and regulatory compliance measures, will act as major drivers for the adoption of data centre and cloud services."

With the market growing at a rapid rate, the number of IaaS providers is also growing in India. In fact, it is becoming increasingly difficult for IT decision-makers to choose what is best for their kind of set-up. This guide will serve as a checklist for choosing the best IaaS provider from amongst the host of options available.

Know your needs

Jason Hoffman, head of cloud technology, product area cloud, business unit - Cloud and IP, Ericsson, says, "This is the most

fundamental and obvious step to be taken at the beginning of the process. This step, if well executed, forms the basis for the entire selection. One needs to know the requirements to understand whether IaaS is actually required or building one's own infrastructure is a better option. The IT decision-makers need to understand the reasons for choosing an IaaS provider rather than building their own infrastructure. They need to evaluate the benefits they will get with IaaS. Once they know that, decision making will be much easier."

In addition, IT decision-makers must clearly articulate their expectations from an IaaS provider. They need to make it clear whether they need IaaS for extra computing power or for additional storage, and which of these is the priority.

Robust infrastructure and service consistency

Signing on an IaaS provider means you are outsourcing an important part of your IT infrastructure. Therefore, it is advisable that you choose a fully managed IaaS cloud solution that runs in an enterprise-class data centre. This would mean that it is more secure, and can be relied on to support and deliver hosted software solutions.

Anil Chandilya, head - data center operations, "Service consistency is the second important factor, particularly because of the way the hosting and cloud industry has grown and continues to grow, with many providers coming in. Most of them are purely infrastructure providers. Though they invest heavily and build a large infrastructure, most of them do not have any technical support background. Building infrastructure and providing it on lease is just one aspect of the hosting business; however, providing technical support and application uptime is the most important aspect of this industry. So while choosing